Flourish
LEGAL WELL-BEING

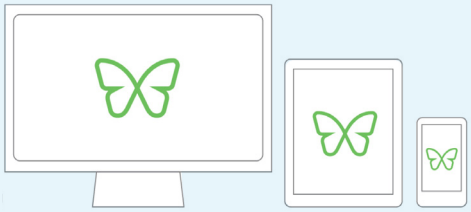
The Guide to Digital Distraction Blocking

If you're not using a distraction blocker app, you're asking for countless hours of distraction and wasted time.

Learning to use a blocker, and use it well, can transform the way you work and shield you from the mood-ruining effects of digital distraction.

Here are 5 ways how:

1 Use the Freedom App
http://freedom.to



It's the most powerful, flexible distraction blocker. (We're not getting a kickback; it's just that good.)

- Install it on your computer and phone.
- It costs money, but not a lot, and — given its benefits — it pays for itself. The free blockers out there just can't compare.

2 If You Binge It, Block It

If you can't enjoy something in moderation (say, TikTok, Netflix, or podcasts), block it entirely.

That may feel aggressive. But you'll love the feeling of freedom and control more than you'll miss the content.

3 Make the Blocker Hard to Shut Off

On your computer, Freedom has options that let you tie your hands so you can't force-quit or use other sneaky workarounds. Use those.

On your phone, though, you can always just delete the app. So:

- Use your phone's Screen Time settings as backup protection.
- Build up the habit of never deleting Freedom until doing so would feel like a mortal sin.

4 Create a Whitelist

Freedom lets you add "website exceptions": sites you can always access, even when it's blocking the whole internet.

Use that for "utility websites" that are important for work or daily life and don't have the potential to distract you.

- Some examples: Google Drive, Google Maps, Google Calendar, Zoom, Yelp, Lastpass, Westlaw.

Then, you can do aggressive, full-internet blocks for deep work sessions without cutting off services you need.

5 Use Both Recurring Blocks and One-Off Blocks

Freedom lets you create blocks that automatically recur on set days at set times. Here's one example of a strong setup:

- A workday block for various distractions and entertainment sites
- A more intense morning block for deep work
- A 9 PM block of the whole internet (except your whitelist)

On top of those blocks, you can create quick one-off blocks (it's easy to do) when you know you'll need to focus intensely.